Larkspur Analytics Employee Handbook 2026

Sample document (fictional company) for testing document Q&A

1. Welcome and Scope

This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Larkspur Analytics Pvt. Ltd., a fictional company created for testing. It is effective from 1 April 2026 and replaces the previous edition dated 1 July 2024 (document reference HR-HB-2024).

Questions about this handbook should be sent to the People Operations team at the Pune office. The policy owner is the Head of People Operations, Meera Iyengar.

Where a local law gives an employee a better benefit than this handbook, the local law applies.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday to Friday, including a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours, when every employee must be reachable, are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM.

Employees may work from home up to 3 days per week with their manager's approval. Employees in their probation period of 6 months must work from the office at least 4 days per week.

Late arrival of more than 30 minutes on more than 3 days in a calendar month will be discussed with the reporting manager. Attendance is recorded in the HRMS portal under clause ATT-04.

3. Leave Policy

Every employee receives 18 days of earned leave per calendar year, credited at 1.5 days per month. Up to 10 unused earned leave days can be carried forward to the next year; any balance above 10 days lapses on 31 December.

Employees also receive 8 days of sick leave per year, which cannot be carried forward. Sick leave of more than 2 consecutive days requires a medical certificate.

Maternity leave is 26 weeks with full pay. Paternity leave is 15 working days, to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption. Bereavement leave is 5 working days.

Leave requests of more than 5 consecutive days must be submitted at least 14 days in advance.

4. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Business travel must be pre-approved by the reporting manager in the expense portal before any booking is made. Domestic flights are booked in economy class. International flights longer than 8 hours may be booked in premium economy.

Daily allowances for meals and local transport are INR 2,500 per day for metro cities (Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad) and INR 1,800 per day for other cities. Hotel stays are capped at INR 7,000 per night in metro cities and INR 5,000 per night elsewhere.

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of the travel end date with original receipts. Claims submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed. Approved claims are paid with the next monthly salary.

Client entertainment above INR 10,000 per event requires prior approval from a department head (policy clause EXP-12).

5. Equipment and IT Security

Each employee receives a company laptop on joining. Laptops are replaced every 4 years, or earlier if repair costs exceed 40% of the replacement value.

Employees receive a one-time home office allowance of INR 15,000 for a chair, desk or monitor, claimable within the first 90 days of employment.

Passwords must be at least 14 characters and must be changed every 180 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, source code and the HRMS portal.

A lost or stolen laptop must be reported to the IT helpdesk within 4 hours at helpdesk@larkspur.example. Company data must never be stored on personal USB drives.

6. Performance Reviews and Compensation

Performance reviews take place twice a year: a mid-year check-in in October and an annual review in April. Ratings use a five-point scale from 1 (Below Expectations) to 5 (Exceptional).

Annual salary revisions are effective from 1 July. Employees rated 4 or 5 are eligible for a performance bonus of up to 15% of annual fixed pay, paid in the August payroll.

Employees who join after 1 January are reviewed in the following cycle and are not eligible for that year's salary revision.

7. Resignation and Notice Period

The notice period is 60 days for employees who have completed probation and 15 days during probation. The notice period may be shortened by mutual agreement or bought out by paying the basic salary for the remaining days.

Final settlement, including unused earned leave encashment of up to 30 days, is paid within 45 days of the last working day. Company equipment must be returned on or before the last working day.

An experience letter and relieving letter are issued within 7 days of the final settlement.